Alex Hossepian

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Education

California State University, Northridge — Northridge, CA

B.S. Computer Information Technology, Minor in Business Analytics | GPA: 3.6 — *Aug. 2023 – May 2027*

- **Coursework**: Network Security, Cloud Security, Network Automation, Systems Administration
- **Activities**: Layer8, CSUN's cybersecurity club; CTF participant

Certifications

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) — July 2026

Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) Training — Mar. 2026

Experience

Information Technology Analyst Intern — Jan. 2026 – Present

Parker Meggitt Aerospace — *Simi Valley, CA*

- Built a PowerShell script standardizing workstation backups to a hardened SMB share across 100+ endpoints, replacing a manual process and producing audit trails for CMMC compliance review
- Administered Active Directory across the enterprise domain: joined 200+ machines, provisioned accounts, and assigned group-based permissions following least privilege
- Configured enterprise Cisco switches including VLAN assignment, port security, and trunk links to segment network traffic
- Aided CMMC Level 2 compliance efforts in a regulated aerospace environment, applying access control and documentation practices to meet audit requirements
- Triaged and documented 20+ tickets weekly, escalating with reproducible notes for senior engineers

Sales Associate — June 2022 – Dec. 2025

Michaels — *Burbank, CA*

- Handled customer service, POS, and online order fulfillment in a high-volume store while enrolled full time; named Employee of the Month twice (Nov. 2023, Oct. 2024)

Security Projects

Homelab Security Operations Center | *Wazuh, Pi-hole, VMware ESXi, pfSense, Active Directory* — May 2023 – Present

- Deployed a Wazuh SIEM manager and enrolled an endpoint agent, centralizing host telemetry, file integrity monitoring, and authentication logs into a single console
- Deployed redundant Pi-hole DNS resolvers on Ubuntu so name resolution survives the loss of either node, enforcing blocklist-based filtering and retaining query logs for visibility into outbound DNS activity
- Built the supporting enterprise environment on an HPE ProLiant DL360 Gen10 (48 cores / 384 GB RAM): ESXi with role-based access control, VLAN segmentation and firewall policy in pfSense/OPNsense, and an Active Directory domain with GPOs and DNS

AWS Honeypot Deployment and Threat Analysis | *T-Pot, AWS EC2, Elastic* — Apr. 2026

- Deployed a T-Pot honeypot on AWS with all ports exposed to the internet, capturing over 21,000 attacks in a single 24-hour window within minutes of going live
- Analyzed telemetry in Elastic dashboards to rank source IPs, destination ports, and countries of origin, isolating the three IPs behind a disproportionate share of total hits
- Enriched top attacker IPs with reputation and WHOIS lookups, attributing traffic to hosting and telecom providers across Vietnam, Singapore, and India
- Investigated an ET EXPLOIT signature for DoublePulsar backdoor traffic, researching the SMB-based post-exploitation implant and documenting findings in a written analysis report

Remote Access VPN with Connection Alerting | *WireGuard, Linux, SMTP, pfSense* — Mar. 2026 – Apr. 2026

- Stood up a WireGuard VPN for encrypted remote access to internal lab subnets, managing peer keys, allowed-IP scoping, and NAT traversal
- Configured a self-hosted SMTP server to email real-time notifications on every VPN peer connection, creating a lightweight monitoring trail for remote access activity
- Limited attack surface by exposing only the VPN listener at the firewall

Hivestorm National Cyber Defense Competition | *Linux, Windows Server* — Sept. 2024 – Oct. 2024

- Competed on a Layer8 club team, hardening Linux and Windows Server images under time pressure by remediating misconfigurations, removing unauthorized accounts, and enforcing password and audit policy

Technical Skills

Security: Wazuh (SIEM), T-Pot, Elastic, Wireshark, Nmap, Hashcat, log analysis, threat intel
Networking: VLANs, segmentation, firewall policy, WireGuard VPN, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Pi-hole, pfSense/OPNsense
Systems: Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy, Ubuntu/Linux administration, VMware ESXi, Proxmox
Cloud: AWS, Azure
Scripting: PowerShell, Bash, Java